A semester in Auckland

Courses, choir rehearsals and life in New Zealand.

Jeremiah J. Pan
Physics · SSE · Shaw College
CUHK-Shenzhen · 2023 entry

OAL Study Abroad Ambassador
Australia and New Zealand







More than the timetable

Four courses
Two Computer Science, one Astronomy, one New Zealand Music History.

Two public performances
AUSC: ANZAC performance
and an end-of-semester concert.

Two ambassador roles
CUHK-Shenzhen Study Abroad Ambassador
Auckland Study Abroad Instagram Ambassador

Both islands
Auckland weekends, a mid-semester trip, and more travelling after exams.







Room to explore



Beyond my major
Computer Science and Music alongside Physics.



City life and nature
A central campus, with the outdoors within reach.



An attractive cost for me
Affordability also shaped my choice of destination.

Start with your degree requirements, graduation plans and personal priorities.

A few things move in parallel

Courses and credit
Check the teaching term and prerequisites.
Save syllabuses; seek home pre-approval.
Keep backup courses.

Admission and insurance
Follow your Auckland offer.
Check visa requirements
and read the insurance terms.

Housing and arrival
Apply for housing; check move-in dates.
Book flights and airport transport.
Arrange phone access on arrival.

Home-university arrangements
Confirm enrolment procedures.
Arrange housing, check-out and storage.
Check fees, scholarships and OAL updates.

Course pre-approval and final credit recognition are separate steps. Current arrangements may vary.

What does it cost?

Reference item	NZD
2027 semester programme fee	14,688.96
2027 semester insurance	499.50
Accommodation per semester	7,000–10,000

Up to 60 points, usually four courses;
student services fee included.

My programme offered a 10% tuition discount.
Confirm current terms and scholarship arrangements with OAL.



Also allow for
Flights, visa, food, phone, transport and travel.

Official reference figures, not my 2026 personal expenses. S1 checked 4 Nov 2026. Housing range is not TTT-specific.

A Physics student choosing across subjects

2 × Computer Science
Major Electives (ME)

A foundation for exploring CS and AI.

1 × Astronomy
Major Elective (ME)

A broader academic perspective.

1 × NZ Music History
General Education (GE)

Local culture and a different approach to GE.



I sought pre-approval for all four courses.
The three non-GE courses were intended to fulfil Physics Major Elective requirements.

My course combination. Final credit recognition depends on formal approval. S2: current course options.

Four courses still need a rhythm

Work outside the classroom
Weekly assignments, reading and revision take time beyond scheduled classes.

Assessment takes different forms
Music History included essays and quizzes, timelines and playlists.

Read the course outline
Some courses have must-pass or double-pass requirements.

Give your ears time to adjust
Accents and speaking speed become more familiar with practice.

My learning experience. S3: threshold requirements depend on each course outline.

Settling into TTT



A room of my own
Space to rest and study.
My walk to class: 5–10 min.



Shared cooking spaces
Cooking, eating and
getting to know neighbours.



People around you
RAs and residence activities
helped me settle in.

Food, friends and time to move









Hiwa membership is included in university housing fees.
Check bookings and activity charges.

Food
Cooking and eating out. Groceries become part of the weekly routine.

Hiwa
A place to exercise and spend time with friends.

My meals, tennis and Hiwa photos. S4: accommodation benefits. Visiting-student housing is mainly self-catered.

People I kept showing up for







Rehearsing in English. Two public performances. And friendships that made the semester.

Watch: La La Land performance
Concert playlist

ANZAC performance / End-of-semester concert · Both links are clickable.

Finding connections beyond class

Two ambassador roles
CUHK-Shenzhen: Australia and New Zealand.
Auckland Instagram Ambassador: a volunteer role I applied for, with weekly Study Abroad posts.

A Study Abroad Team field trip
A conservation programme on Motuihe Island: environmental volunteer work on the island.

Club Expo is a starting point
Join clubs you enjoy, take part during the semester, and find ways to connect with the local community.







My experiences; activities vary by semester. Photos show time with friends, not the Motuihe field trip.

Bus trips and train windows









Christchurch · Queenstown
Milford Sound · Lake Tekapo
Two weeks at mid-semester with two friends.

InterCity between towns; verify schedules.
After exams: North Island by train,
then a winter return to the South Island.

My travels. AI helped organise ideas; verify official information. S5: compare FlexiPass and individual fares.

Find your balance; know where to turn

Keep backup courses
Availability, prerequisites and timetable clashes can change your plans.

Make space for your own life
Balance studying, rehearsals and sport, with time to enjoy being there.

Look for activities actively
Check university websites yourself. Join clubs at Club Expo and subscribe to their activity emails.

Plan your night-time return
Go together; stay aware of your surroundings. Move away from trouble and avoid confrontation.

Emergency: 111

Non-emergency: 105 or the online Police reporting form.

Campus Security: **0800 373 7550**

Your programme ambassador may help connect you with OAL or host-university staff.

Activity channels: personal experience. S6 and S11: safety contacts checked 4 Nov 2026.

WHAT I BROUGHT HOME

A clearer sense of what comes next.

A direction in CS and AI.
Experience living somewhere unfamiliar.
Confidence using English and connecting.

Thank you!

Jeremiah J. Pan
Q&A · 5 minutes

Scan to download slides



Arrival and return checklist

Before arrival / first week

Confirm check-in and airport transport.
Prepare phone access, payment and essentials.
Log into email, Canvas and enrolment systems.
Attend orientation; find support services.
Check current AT student concessions.

Before leaving / returning home

Follow check-out rules and return keys.
Keep transcripts and course outlines.
Apply for final credit transfer.
Confirm enrolment and housing at home.
Complete OAL feedback requirements.

NZTD: air travellers can submit from 24 hours before starting their journey to New Zealand.
Check official rules on food, medicines and outdoor equipment before packing.

S7: New Zealand Traveller Declaration. Follow current programme instructions for other procedures.

APPENDIX B

What to check when choosing courses

What to check	Where to look or whom to ask
Teaching term and campus	Curriculum Catalogue and course outlines
Prerequisites and restrictions	Course staff or Study Abroad Team
Assessment and workload	Digital Course Outlines; must-pass requirements
Intended home credit category	Home faculty pre-approval; keep written replies
Final credit recognition	Transcript and formal home-university approval

My case: I sought pre-approval for all four courses.
Final recognition depends on the formal decision.

Host enrolment and home credit recognition are separate. S2: course options. S3: Assessment of Courses Procedures.

APPENDIX C

Official information

S1 Costs and fees: tuition, insurance and accommodation

S2 Course options: availability and restrictions

S3 Assessment of Courses Procedures: threshold requirements

S4 University Accommodation: benefits and Hiwa

S5 InterCity FlexiPass: eligible services and booking

Click a source title to open its website.
Confirm current programme terms with OAL and the relevant university offices.

Sources checked 3 Nov 2026; fees, course restrictions and safety contacts rechecked 4 Nov 2026.

APPENDIX D

Official information

S6 University Security: campus help and safety

S7 New Zealand Traveller Declaration: arrival declaration

S8 Immigration New Zealand: Fee Paying Student Visa

S9 University of Auckland: important dates

S10 CUHK-Shenzhen OAL: 2026–2027 programme announcement

S11 New Zealand Police: 111, 105 and online reporting

Click a source title to open its website.
Confirm current programme terms with OAL and the relevant university offices.

Sources checked 3 Nov 2026; fees, course restrictions and safety contacts rechecked 4 Nov 2026.